

Class 10th | English



First Flight
Chapter Name:
DUST OF SNOW



Dust of Snow

Ch

• 1. poet

==

• 2. poem K.P

- 5-7 word.

Dust of Snow

→ Title
Justi.

The way a crow
Shook down on me
The dust of snow
From a hemlock tree

Has given my heart
A change of mood
And saved (some part)
Of a day I had rued.

neg(-) → bad om

(+) Poet

neg(-) → Poison

Poet

→ enj.

ruined

uplift



Explanation

In the first stanza, the poet describes a simple natural happening.

The snowy flakes have covered the top of the trees.

The poet ^{was} ~~is~~ standing under a hemlock tree.

The movement and alighting of a crow on that tree, ~~make~~ ^{made} the dust of snowfall on the poet.

The falling of snowy flakes and the scene leave ~~s~~ ^a tremendous effect on the mental state and mood of the poet.



Explanation

So far, the day has been quite gloomy and a wastage for him. But this ordinary natural happening suddenly brings a desired change in his mood.

It gladdens his heart. He realises that the falling of snowy flakes on him, has saved the day.

Now he has no regret as the whole of the day has not gone waste.

The moments of the snowfall, and their effect have saved the day.

They have brought a change in his mood and gladdened and uplifted his spirits.



Lets Discuss

This poem presents a moment that seems simple, but has a larger significance.

[Compare this other quotation from Robert Frost: "Always, always a larger significance...

A little thing touches a larger thing.")



Lets Discuss

#1MP

The crow: A symbol of ill omen

The Hemlock Tree: Inauspicious thing, poisonous.

Snow Flakes: Calming element of Nature



Think it out-

1. Justify the title - "Dust of Snow".
2. Compare a similar occurrence in your life with this poem. 3m.

Themes

- Winter Sadness
- Healing Properties of Nature #

3-4

Setting

- The poem is set in a snowy forest.



Poetic Devices

- **Rhyme scheme** - **Abab cdcd**
- **Alliteration** - The repetition of the d in "down" and "dust". The repetition of the h in "hemlock," "has," and "hearth".
- **Metaphor** - The phrase "dust of snow" compares snowflakes to dust, which is usually seen as coarse or mundane.
- **Imagery** - The phrase "dust of snow" evokes a visual image of a light dusting of snow.
- **Oxymoron** - The poet uses the words "crow" and "snow" to contrast something dark and doomy with something light and pure.

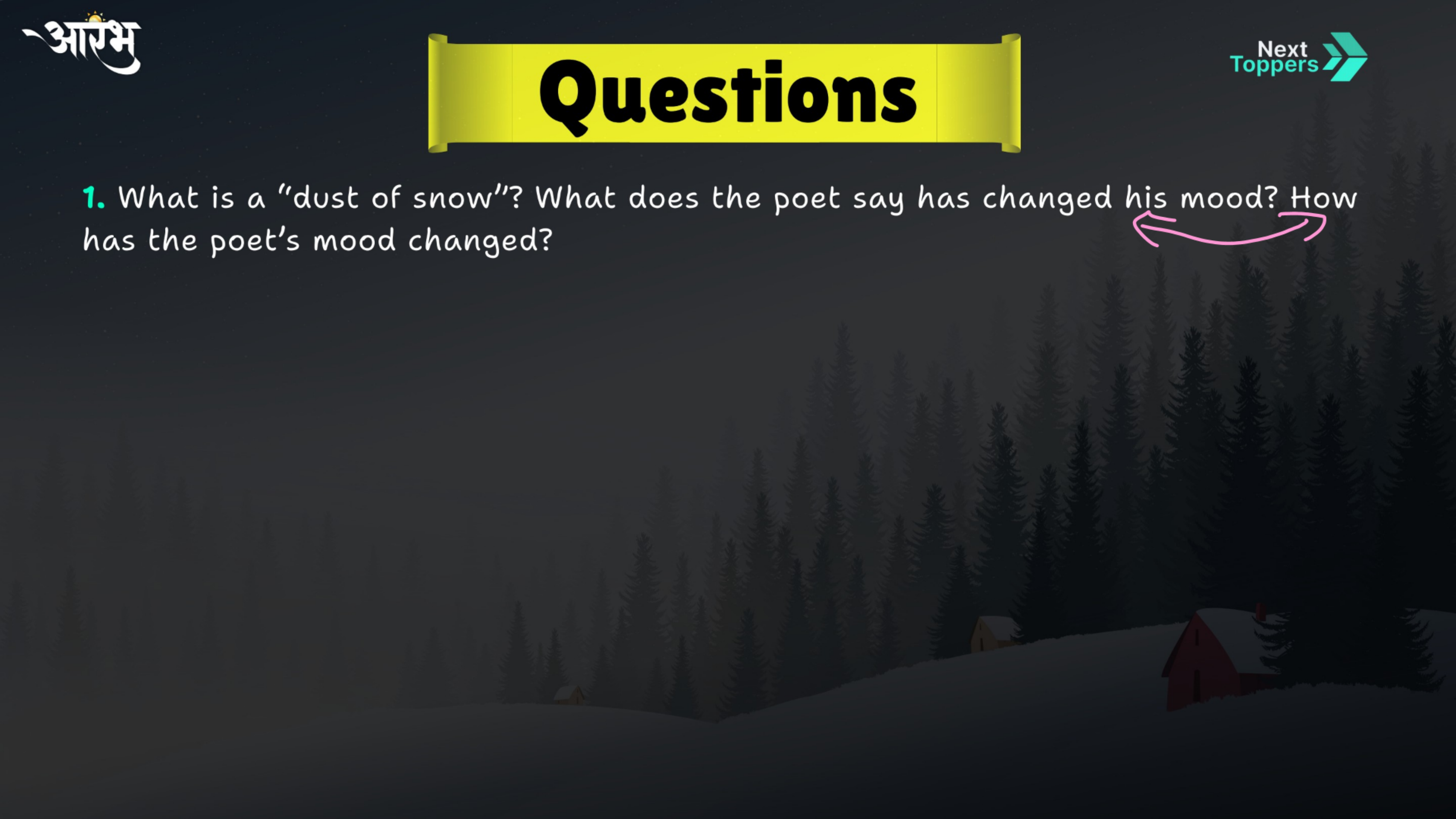
Poetic Devices

3

- **Symbolism** - The poet uses the hemlock tree as a symbol of death and the crow as a symbol of something inauspicious.
- **Enjambment** - "The poet continues sentences to the next line without using punctuation marks."
- **Assonance** - The sound of the vowel "o" is prominent in the line "shook down on me".
- **Irony** - The crow is not a sign of goodluck, but is still able to improve the poet's day. Same for hemlock tree.

Questions

1. What is a "dust of snow"? What does the poet say has changed his mood? How has the poet's mood changed?



Questions

2. How does Frost present nature in this poem? The following questions may help you to think of an answer. Crow

- (i) What are the birds that are usually named in poems? Do you think a crow is often mentioned in poems? What images come to your mind when you think of a crow?
- (ii) Again, what is "a hemlock tree"? Why doesn't the poet write about a more 'beautiful' tree such as a maple, or an oak, or a pine? (iii) What do the 'crow' and 'hemlock' represent — joy or sorrow? What does the dust of snow that the crow shakes off a hemlock tree stand for?

Calming
f.

Questions

→ Yes

3. Have there been times when you felt depressed or hopeless? Have you experienced a similar moment that changed your mood that day?

Thank You.

